

30-DAY ACTION PLAN

THE AI-PROOF JOB PLAYBOOK

Stay indispensable at work—use AI
without becoming replaceable.

ROLE AUDIT

PROMPTS

CALENDAR

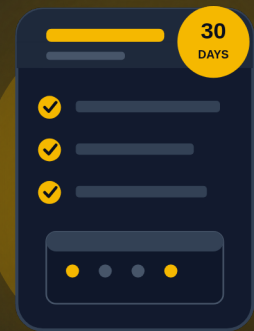


Table of Contents

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. How to Use This Playbook | 11. Section 9: LinkedIn and Resume Refresh Checklist |
| 2. Foreword | 12. Section 10: The 30-Day Calendar |
| 3. Section 1: Why This Matters Now | 13. Section 11: When Layoffs Happen — 48-Hour Plan |
| 4. Section 2: The 15-Minute Role Audit | 14. Section 12: Team AI Guidelines (Bonus) |
| 5. Section 3: What AI Can and Cannot Replace | 15. Section 13: Industry Quick Wins |
| 6. Section 4: The 10 Human Edge Skills | 16. Section 14: FAQ |
| 7. Section 5: Week 1 — Document Your Unique Value | 17. Section 15: 30-Day Tracker Worksheet |
| 8. Section 6: Copy-Paste AI Prompts for Daily Work | 18. Section 16: The "Do Not Do" List |
| 9. Section 7: The Conversation — Getting AI Tools at Work | 19. Section 17: Next 90 Days |
| 10. Section 8: The 7-Day Upskilling Sprint | 20. Quick Reference Checklists |
| | 21. Final Word |

How to Use This Playbook

You don't need a heroic weekend. You need a few small wins stacked on each other—like a competent adult, not a montage sequence.

The lazy person's fast path (this actually works):

1. **Today (15 min):** Do the Role Audit, Part A only. Section 2. Set a timer. Stop when it rings.
2. **This week (30 min/day):** Run the 7-Day Sprint in Section 8. Yes, there's a table. Tables are your friend.
3. **This month:** Follow the calendar in Section 10. It's literally dated so you don't have to think.

Every exercise in this book has two labels: **Why this matters** (so you don't quit halfway) and **How** (plain steps—no ambiguity, no "leverage synergies").

Check boxes as you go. The goal isn't to become an AI influencer. It's to become the person your team can't accidentally replace because nobody wrote down what you actually do.

Foreword

You didn't buy a panic button. You bought a plan.

If you're reading this, something in you refused to just... wait. Wait for HR. Wait for the all-hands. Wait for your manager to figure it out between back-to-back meetings and a quarterly offsite about "synergy."

You spent money—or time, which is also money—on *yourself*. That matters more than you think.

Most people respond to AI anxiety in one of three ways:

1. **Denial** — "It'll blow over." (It won't blow over. It'll evolve.)
2. **Doom** — "I'm already obsolete." (You're not; you're under-documented.)
3. **Preparation** — "What can I actually do this month?" (Hi. That's you.)

Option 3 is the only one that ages well. And it's the only one that makes you feel better on a Tuesday.

We've seen this movie before (the ending isn't what you think)

Every few decades, a tool shows up and an entire profession declares the apocalypse. Then something stranger happens: the profession **changes shape** and the people who adapt early end up *more* valuable, not less.

This isn't toxic positivity. Some roles do compress. Some tasks disappear. But the historical pattern is not "machine replaces everyone." It's "machine eats the boring middle; humans who climb toward judgment, relationships, and quality control thrive."

Here are industries that were *supposed* to be finished—and what actually happened:

Graphic design was declared dead the week image generators went viral. Designers were going to be replaced by prompts and stock assets. Instead? Business design spend has *increased* for most companies surveyed in 2026. What got automated was the grunt work—mockups, variations, resizing. What got *more* valuable was taste, brand strategy, and knowing what *not* to ship. The bottom of the market compressed. The top expanded. Designers who learned AI didn't vanish—they stopped being human photocopiers and started being creative directors of their own output.

Law was the classic "AI reads contracts, lawyers go home" headline. Reality check: legal AI adoption is now mainstream, and many firms report higher throughput, faster turnaround, and associates spending less time on rote review and more on advice clients actually pay premium rates for. Ironclad's 2026 industry data found a majority of legal professionals see AI as a job *creator*, not eliminator—when it's used to handle volume, not to hide from clients. The lawyers winning aren't the ones pretending Lexis never happened. They're the ones who review AI output with a red pen and a brain.

Software development had the "Copilot will replace coders" era. Joke's on the alarmists: developers using AI assistants ship faster and spend more time on architecture, debugging weird edge cases, and asking "should we even build this?"—which, inconveniently for the

robots, is the whole ballgame. Half of designers in recent surveys now ship AI-assisted code to production. The bar moved up, not out.

Customer support was the obvious kill shot—chatbots answering everything! What happened? Tier-one got automated. Escalations, angry humans, nuanced policy exceptions, and "I know this account's history" got *more* important. The best support people became triage artists and trust-rebuilders, not script readers.

Radiology and clinical imaging scared people with AI that flags anomalies in scans. Radiologists weren't replaced—they got a tireless first pass that pre-sorts the queue. The human still owns the diagnosis, the patient conversation, and the liability. AI handles volume; humans handle consequence.

Marketing and copywriting faced the "AI writes all the blogs now" panic. Floods of generic content followed. And then something predictable: audiences and algorithms started rewarding *distinctive* voice, strategy, and brand coherence. AI writes drafts. Humans write *decisions*.

Notice the pattern? **AI didn't delete professions. It deleted the worst parts of them**—the repetitive, low-judgment, invisible grunt work—and it punished people who clung to that layer as their whole identity.

That's uncomfortable. It's also an opportunity if you move on purpose.

Why this playbook is different from scrolling at 11 p.m.

You don't need another article titled "10 AI Tools That Will Change Everything (Number 7 Will Shock You)." You need:

- A **role audit** so you know what's actually at risk in *your* job—not someone else's viral LinkedIn post
- **Prompts you can paste today** without pretending to be an engineer
- **Scripts for talking to your manager** without sounding like you're asking permission to cheat
- A **30-day calendar** because motivation is a liar and structure is your friend
- A **layoff plan** you hope you never need but will be glad you have

This isn't theory. It's a operating system for the next month of your working life.

What this investment actually buys you

Let's be direct about ROI—because you deserve honesty, not hustle-bro math.

If you do nothing: You stay anxious, invisible, and reactive. Maybe fine. Maybe fine until the next reorg, new tool mandate, or colleague who *did* prepare gets the interesting projects.

If you run this playbook for 30 days:

Investment	Likely return
15-minute role audit	Clarity on where you're safe vs. exposed

Investment	Likely return
2 AI workflows	3–8 hours/week back (conservative estimate)
Value one-pager	Manager sees you as proactive, not passive
LinkedIn/resume refresh	Options outside your current employer
Visibility conversation	Reduced "who is that person?" risk in decisions

Even one saved hour per week is 52 hours a year—more than a full work week you get back for higher-value work, rest, or a side project. This guide costs less than most people spend on lunch in a week. The asymmetry is absurd, and you were smart to notice it.

You didn't buy a PDF. You bought:

- **Agency** — a shift from "happening to me" to "I'm running a experiment"
- **Evidence** — proof you can point to if your role is questioned
- **Optionality** — skills and language that travel if your company doesn't

That's not a expense. That's career insurance with a sense of humor and fill-in-the-blank worksheets.

A note from the voice in your head (and a reply)

Your brain: "What if I do all this and still get laid off?"

This book: Then you'll leave with a sharper story, updated materials, and workflows that work anywhere—not with a blank stare and a folder of unfinished drafts.

Your brain: "What if I'm too late?"

This book: Most of your colleagues are still doing nothing except forwarding alarming articles to the group chat. You're not late. You're early with a plan, which is the only version of "early" that pays rent.

Your brain: "What if AI gets so good none of this matters?"

This book: Then judgment, trust, accountability, and relationships become *more* scarce, not less. This playbook trains exactly those muscles—using AI as the weight machine, not the competitor.

How to read what follows

Skim if you must. But do the **role audit** and **one prompt on real work** before you judge whether this was worth it. Experience beats opinion.

The sections ahead are practical on purpose. The Final Word at the end is emotional on purpose. You need both: a map *and* someone saying you can actually walk the route.

You already made the hard decision—you chose preparation over paralysis. That alone puts you ahead of most of the workforce, including several people with fancier titles than yours.

Welcome to the playbook.

Now turn the page. Section 1 is where the map starts—and no, the map is not generated by AI. The team at **MindWizard** wrote the checklist because we care whether you succeed.

— MindWizard

Section 1: Why This Matters Now (And What Actually Changed)

Here's the weird part: in 2026, **people are more scared of AI than AI has earned**. Layoffs are real in some sectors. But for most office workers, the gap is this—**panic is high, preparation is low**. That gap is where you win.

What's actually happening (no hype):

- Workers worry about replacement more than the job market justifies.
- Most employers still haven't sent the "here's how to use AI" email. You know the one. It doesn't exist.
- Your coworkers are already using AI on the sly. You're not behind—you're just not documented yet.

Three ways people cope (pick your fighter):

Mistake	What it looks like	Better move
Ostrich mode	"It'll blow over"	Learn 3 workflows. Save 5 hours/week. Become useful on purpose.
Secret agent	Using AI but hiding it	Frame it as productivity. Offer to show the team. Look like a leader, not a cheater.
Panic hop	Quitting with no story	Build your value proof first. <i>Then</i> choose your timing.

Your north star for 30 days:

Be the person who makes AI useful and keeps the human judgment nobody trusts a bot with.

Exercise: Your 15-minute start

Why this matters: Motion kills anxiety better than another podcast. One small action tells your brain you're not helpless.

How:

1. Open your calendar. Create an event tomorrow: "Role audit, 15 min."
2. Flip to Section 2. Fill in only Part A—the one-sentence job description.
3. Text yourself the name of one boring task you'll try AI on this week.

Done when: You have a calendar block and one task written down. That's it. You're started.

Section 2: The 15-Minute Role Audit

Most people upskill randomly—watch a YouTube video, panic-bookmark an article, feel briefly better, change nothing. Don't be most people.

This audit answers one question: **Where do you actually matter?** Fifteen minutes. Timer on. Phone face-down. Go.

Part A: Your job in one sentence

Why this matters: If you can't say what you do in one sentence, your manager probably can't either. That's how people get surprised by reorgs.

How: Fill in the blank—out loud first, then on paper:

I help _____ achieve _____ by _____.

Example: *I help the sales team close deals faster by preparing proposals and coordinating follow-ups.*

Part B: Task breakdown

Why this matters: AI eats repetitive tasks. You need to know which of yours are on the menu.

How:

1. List your top 10 recurring tasks—the stuff that shows up every week.
2. For each, answer two questions: Could AI do 80% of this? Does it need *my* judgment?
3. Don't overthink. First instinct is fine.

Task	Hours/week	AI could do 80%+? (Y/N)	Needs my judgment? (Y/N)
1.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
5.			
6.			
7.			
8.			
9.			
10.			

Part C: Your automation exposure score

Why this matters: This tells you whether to chill, focus, or sprint—not so you panic, so you prioritize.

How: Count the "Y" answers in the "AI could do 80%" column.

- **0–3 Y's:** Lower exposure. Good. Become the person who helps your team use AI well.
- **4–6 Y's:** Mixed bag. Double down on judgment tasks and write down your wins.
- **7–10 Y's:** Urgent but not hopeless. Shift time toward relationships, decisions, and the stuff only you know.

Part D: Your hidden value

Why this matters: This is your real job security—the stuff not in the org chart or the AI's training data.

How: Answer these three questions. Bullet points. No essay.

1. What do people ask *you* specifically—not the team, *you*?
2. What breaks if you're out sick for a week?
3. What do you know that isn't written down anywhere?

Your "only me" list:

- _____
- _____
- _____

Done when: You have at least three bullets. These are what you protect and brag about (politely) for the next 30 days.

Section 3: What AI Can and Cannot Replace (In Your Job)

Stop asking "Will AI take my job?" Ask: **Which parts of my job—and which parts of me—are actually hard to replace?**

AI is great at (let it have these):

- First drafts—emails, reports, summaries, slides
- Sorting, tagging, pattern-spotting in data
- Reformatting the same info seventeen different ways
- Research summaries from public sources
- "Here's a starting point" on almost anything

AI is terrible at (this is you):

- Owning it when something goes wrong
- Reading the room when the client is furious but polite
- Navigating that one colleague who communicates exclusively in subtext
- Ethical calls with real consequences
- Trust built over months
- Saying "this data looks wrong" and being right

The formula nobody prints on a motivational poster:

$$\text{Visible value} = (\text{Judgment} \times \text{Relationships} \times \text{Results}) \div \text{Invisibility}$$

If you do solid work in a cave, AI doesn't have to be *better* than you—it just has to be cheaper and good enough. Your job this month: **get less invisible**.

Quick examples (find yourself):

- **Marketing:** AI drafts posts. You decide what ships, what waits, and what would embarrass the brand.
- **Ops/admin:** AI summarizes threads. You know which vendor relationship is one email from explosion.
- **Support:** AI suggests replies. You hear the customer who's about to churn and actually care.

Exercise: One visible human move

Why this matters: One visible act of judgment beats ten hours of invisible AI speed.

How:

1. Pick one item from the "AI is terrible at" list above.
2. Do it this week—on purpose, where someone notices.
3. Examples: mentor someone for 15 minutes, lead a retro, send a recommendation with your name on it.

Done when: One person could describe what you did. That's visibility.

Section 4: The 10 Human Edge Skills

You don't need all ten. That's a personality test, not a homework assignment. **Pick three.** Strengthen those. Ignore the rest until next month.

Why this matters: These are the muscles AI can't rent. They're also what managers describe when they say "we need to keep *them*."

#	Skill	One thing to try this week
1	Synthesis under ambiguity	One paragraph: "Here's what we should do" from messy inputs
2	Stakeholder translation	Take one technical thing and explain it to a non-expert
3	Exception handling	Write down how you fixed one "not in the manual" problem
4	Trust building	Close one loop you've been avoiding (email counts)
5	Quality control	Catch one AI mistake before anyone else sees it
6	Prioritization	Say out loud: "I'm not doing X this week"
7	Cross-team coordination	Own one handoff that usually dies between teams
8	Mentoring	Show one person a 5-minute trick they didn't know
9	Customer empathy	Handle one case with context, not copy-paste

#	Skill	One thing to try this week
10	Institutional memory	Write why a past decision was made before everyone forgets

Exercise: Pick your three

Why this matters: Scattered effort feels busy and changes nothing. Three focus areas create a story you can tell in a 1:1.

How:

1. Circle three skills from the table. Gut feel is fine.
2. Schedule one tiny action for each (see the table—nothing takes more than 30 minutes).
3. Put all three on your calendar this week. Treat them like meetings with yourself.

My 3 skills	Scheduled for (day)	Done?
1.		☐
2.		☐
3.		☐

Section 5: Week 1 — Document Your Unique Value

Managers don't remember your effort. They remember **evidence**. "I worked hard" is not evidence. "I cut onboarding from 5 days to 2" is.

This week you build a one-page proof doc. Thirty minutes a day. Less if you're efficient. More if you're a perfectionist (please don't be).

Day 1 — Outcome inventory

Why: You can't pitch value you haven't named.

How: List 5 wins from the last 90 days. Numbers help but aren't required. "Fixed the thing everyone complained about" counts.

Day 2 — Before/after stories

Why: Stories stick. Bullet points fade.

How: Pick 2 problems you solved. Write: *Situation* → *What I did* → *What changed*. Three sentences each. Stop.

Day 3 — AI-assisted win

Why: You need a real example that AI helps you—not replaces you.

How:

1. Use AI on one actual task.
2. Screenshot or save the prompt and raw output.
3. Write one sentence: "I changed X before sending because Y."

That edit is your value. Write it down.

Day 4 — Testimonial hunt

Why: Other people's words are more believable than yours.

How:

1. Search Slack/email for "thanks," "great job," or "you saved."
2. Find 2 examples.
3. Ask permission to quote one internally. If verbal, write down what they said.

Day 5 — One-pager draft

Why: One page = manager might actually read it.

How: Fill in the template below. Ugly is fine. Complete is better.

Day 6-7 — Share it

Why: A one-pager in a folder is a diary. A one-pager in your manager's inbox is career infrastructure.

How: Send it using the script in Section 7. Attach or paste. Hit send before you overthink.

Value one-pager template

NAME | ROLE | DATE

TOP OUTCOMES (last 90 days)

-
-
-

SIGNATURE STRENGTHS

-
-

AI WORKFLOW I OWN

Task:

Tool:

Time saved:

What I always check before sending:

FOCUS NEXT QUARTER

-

Section 6: Copy-Paste AI Prompts for Daily Work

These are not magic spells. They're **draft machines**. You are the editor, the fact-checker, and the person whose name goes on the send button.

Use ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or whatever your company approves. Paste. Tweak the bracketed parts. **Always read before you ship.** AI lies with confidence. You've met humans like that. Same energy.

How to use any prompt below:

1. Copy the whole block.
2. Replace anything in [BRACKETS] with your real info.
3. Run it.
4. Run the quality checklist at the end before anyone sees the output.

Prompt 1: Weekly status report

When to use: Friday afternoon, staring at scattered notes, dreading the status email.

Why it works: You already did the work. This just turns brain-dump into manager-friendly bullets.

```
You are my executive assistant. I will paste rough notes from my week.
```

```
Turn them into a status report with:
```

- 3 bullet accomplishments (outcome-focused)
- 2 bullets in progress (with blockers if any)
- 1 bullet next week priorities
- Tone: professional, concise, no jargon

```
My notes:
```

```
[PASTE HERE]
```

Prompt 2: Meeting prep brief

When to use: 30 minutes before a meeting you haven't prepped for (we don't judge).

Why it works: Walks in with talking points beats walks in with hope.

```
I have a meeting about [TOPIC] with [AUDIENCE].
```

```
Create a 1-page brief:
```

1. Likely questions they will ask
2. 3 talking points aligned to their priorities
3. Risks or objections I should prepare for
4. Suggested ask or decision at the end

```
Context about the meeting:
```

```
[PASTE AGENDA OR EMAIL THREAD]
```

Prompt 3: Email tone rewrite

When to use: You wrote it angry, or rambly, or both.

Why it works: Saves relationships. You still approve every word.

Rewrite this email to be [shorter / more diplomatic / more direct / warmer].

Keep all facts accurate. Do not add commitments I did not make.

Original email:

[PASTE HERE]

Prompt 4: Project post-mortem draft

When to use: Something went sideways and leadership wants "learnings."

Why it works: Structure beats staring at a blank doc wondering who's to blame.

Help me draft a post-mortem from these bullets.

Sections: What happened | Root cause | What worked | What to change | Owner + due date for each action

Bullets:

[PASTE HERE]

Prompt 5: Learning plan for a new skill

When to use: You've been told to "get up to speed" on something vague.

Why it works: Turns panic into a 7-day plan your brain can actually follow.

I need to get competent at [SKILL] for my job as [ROLE] within [TIMEFRAME].

Create a 7-day plan:

- 30 min/day max
- Free resources only
- Each day: one concept + one practical exercise tied to my real work

My current level: [beginner / intermediate]

Prompt 6: Difficult conversation prep

When to use: You need to say the thing and not torch the relationship.

Why it works: Rehearsal reduces the "I wish I'd said..." spiral afterward.

I need to have a conversation with [PERSON/ROLE] about [ISSUE].

Give me:

- Opening line (non-accusatory)
- 3 key points to make
- 2 likely responses and how to reply
- A closing that preserves the relationship

Context:

[PASTE NEUTRAL SUMMARY]

Prompt 7: Slide outline from messy notes

When to use: You have notes. You do not have a deck.

Why it works: Outline first, slides second—skips the blank-slide-of-doom phase.

```
Turn these notes into a 8-slide presentation outline.

Audience: [WHO]
Goal: [DECISION / UPDATE / PITCH]

For each slide: title, 3 bullets max, speaker note (1 sentence).

Notes:
[PASTE HERE]
```

Prompt 8: Performance review self-assessment

When to use: Review season. You'd rather eat drywall than write about yourself.

Why it works: Gives you a draft to edit instead of a cursor blinking at your soul.

```
I am preparing a self-assessment for my performance review.

Role: [TITLE]
Review period: [DATES]

From these rough notes, write:
1. Three accomplishment bullets (metrics where possible)
2. Two growth areas (honest but forward-looking)
3. Three goals for next period aligned to team priorities

Tone: confident, factual, not arrogant.

My notes:
[PASTE PROJECTS, WINS, FEEDBACK]
```

Prompt 9: Competitor / market snapshot (public info only)

When to use: You need to sound informed in a meeting by Thursday.

Why it works: Starting points + "verify this" flags beat winging it. **You still verify.**

```
I need a quick landscape view for [TOPIC/INDUSTRY].

Based only on general knowledge (I will verify separately), provide:
- 5 key trends in 2026
- 3 implications for [MY ROLE/COMPANY TYPE]
- 2 questions I should research this week

Do not invent specific statistics. Flag anything that needs verification.
```

Prompt 10: Delegation brief for a teammate

When to use: You need to hand something off without the "wait, what?" follow-up emails.

Why it works: Clear "done" definition prevents you from re-doing it at 9 p.m.

I need to delegate [TASK] to [ROLE].

Create:

- Clear outcome definition (what "done" looks like)
- 5-step checklist
- Common pitfalls
- Suggested check-in date

Context:

[PASTE BACKGROUND]

Quality control checklist (use every time—non-negotiable)

Why: This is the difference between "AI user" and "person who got fired for an AI email."

How: Before you send anything AI touched, check every box:

- ☐ Names, numbers, and dates are correct
- ☐ It didn't invent facts, citations, or promises you didn't make
- ☐ Tone won't make your boss do the eyebrow thing
- ☐ You added at least one thing only you would know
- ☐ You'd put your name on it without wincing

Section 7: The Conversation — Getting AI Tools at Work

Most people never ask. They just... sneak. Then wonder why they feel guilty at standup.

Asking well makes you look like a **leader**, not a kid who found the answer key. Here's how.

Exercise: Email your manager

Why this matters: Visibility + permission = you can't get blamed for "going rogue."

How:

1. Copy the script below.
2. Fill in [BRACKETS] with one real task and real numbers (estimate is fine).
3. Send. Today. Before you talk yourself out of it.

Subject: Quick win – AI workflow for [specific task]

Hi [Manager],

I've been testing AI on [specific task] and cut the time from [X] to [Y] while keeping quality checks in place.

I'd like to:

1. Document the workflow for the team
2. Confirm we're aligned on approved tools / data policies
3. Share results at [next team meeting / 1:1]

Happy to walk you through a 10-minute demo this week.

[Your name]

If your company restricts AI tools

Why ask instead of sneak: Getting caught with client data in the wrong tool is a career event. A bad one.

How: Send one of these—pick the least scary:

- "What's the approved way to use AI on [task type]?"
- "Can we pilot one workflow with IT?"
- "Is [approved tool] the only option, or is there a sandbox?"

Compliance-aware beats clever. Every time.

If your manager is skeptical

Why: They're thinking about risk, not your productivity. Address risk first.

How: Say one of these—verbatim is fine:

- "I verify everything before it goes out."
- "AI does the draft. I own the final call."
- "Happy to start with internal docs only—zero customer data."

Section 8: The 7-Day Upskilling Sprint

No coding. No courses. No "watch 6 hours of tutorials." Thirty to forty-five minutes a day. One week. That's the deal.

Why this matters: A week of small actions beats a year of "I should really look into that."

Day	Focus	Your task
1	Tool setup	Find out what's allowed. Make accounts. Skim the data policy. Stop.
2	First win	Pick your most boring recurring task. Run Prompt 1 or 3 on real work.
3	Quality control	Find one thing wrong in AI output. Fix it. That's your whole job today.
4	Tell one person	5-minute demo for one colleague. Their questions = gold.
5	LinkedIn (optional)	One short post. Template in Section 9. Skip if it makes you cringe—do internal visibility instead.
6	Second workflow	Add meeting prep or email rewrite. Same quality checklist.
7	Wrap up	Update your one-pager with time saved. Pat yourself on back.

Exercise: Sprint check-in

Why: If you can't name what you did, it didn't count.

How: Friday of sprint week, check every box:

- ☐ Two AI workflows used on real work (not practice prompts)
- ☐ Quality checklist used at least 5 times

- ☐ One teammate knows what you're doing
- ☐ One-pager updated with at least one number

Section 9: LinkedIn and Resume Refresh Checklist

You're not "a ChatGPT user." You're someone who **delivers outcomes**. AI is a method, like Excel or caffeine.

Exercise: Rewrite one bullet

Why this matters: "Used AI" sounds like a hobby. "Cut reporting time 40%" sounds like rent money.

How:

1. Find one resume or LinkedIn bullet about your work.
2. Rewrite using: **[Action] + [outcome] + [how] + [scale if you have it]**.
3. Read it out loud. If you cringe, simplify.

Swap this → for this:

Don't write	Write instead
"Used ChatGPT"	"Cut weekly reporting from 3 hours to 45 minutes with AI-assisted drafts + manual QA"
"AI enthusiast"	"Known for turning messy inputs into exec-ready recommendations"

LinkedIn post (low cringe version)

Why: One post = 500 people know you're adapting, not hiding.

How: Copy, fill in brackets, post. Or skip and tell your manager instead. Visibility beats platform.

One thing I changed about how I work this month:

[Specific task] used to take me [X hours].
Now: [brief process – draft with AI, verify, add judgment].

The part that still requires a human: [your specific edge – relationships, QA, context, etc.]

If you're in [role/industry], happy to share the workflow.

Resume bullet formula

[Action verb] + [outcome] + [method/tool] + [scale if possible]

Examples:

- *Streamlined client onboarding documentation, cutting turnaround from 5 days to 2, using AI-assisted drafting with legal review.*

- *Prepared executive briefing materials for 12 board meetings; owned final narrative and stakeholder alignment.*

30-minute profile refresh

Why: Recruiters and hiring managers Google you. Give them something current.

How: Set a timer for 30 minutes. Stop when it rings.

- ☐ Headline = outcome, not just job title
- ☐ About section = 2 wins with numbers (or "before/after" stories)
- ☐ Skills = only tools you actually use
- ☐ Featured = one thing you're proud of (post, doc, project)
- ☐ "Open to Work" = on only if you mean it (recruiters notice everything)

Section 10: The 30-Day Calendar

Motivation is unreliable. **Dates on a calendar are reliable.** Here's your month.

Week	Theme	What "done" looks like
1	Map & document	Role audit finished + one-pager drafted
2	Automate drafts	2 AI workflows in daily use
3	Get visible	One teammate trained + one visibility action
4	Future-proof	Profile updated + manager conversation had

Week 2 — go deeper

Why: Second workflow proves the first wasn't a fluke.

How: Mon = pick task #2 from audit. Tue–Wed = test prompts. Thu = quality check 3 outputs. Fri = write down hours saved (guess is fine).

Week 3 — show your work

Why: Secret productivity is a hobby. Visible productivity is career capital.

How: Mon = 10-min demo for one person. Wed = write workflow in shared doc. Fri = LinkedIn post OR tell manager what you learned.

Week 4 — close the loop

Why: Turn a sprint into a story someone else could repeat.

How: Mon = resume/LinkedIn (Section 9). Wed = manager email (Section 7). Fri = answer the 4 questions below out loud.

Exercise: 30-day retrospective

Why: Without reflection, you just had a busy month. With it, you have a narrative.

How: Answer these four questions. Bullet points. Five minutes.

1. Which tasks stay AI-assisted forever?
2. Which tasks stay 100% human?
3. What new work do I want with my saved time?
4. What proof do I have if someone questions my role?

Section 11: When Layoffs Happen — Your 48-Hour Plan

Hope you never need this. **Have it anyway.** The people who freeze lose options. The people who activate—even while scared—keep them. This isn't pessimism. It's a seatbelt.

Hour 0–24: Don't panic-post, do this

Why: Your first day sets the tone for the next six months. Panic-posting on LinkedIn is forever.

How:

- ☐ Save your one-pager and work samples (respect IP—don't exfiltrate code)
- ☐ List 10 people who'd actually take your call
- ☐ Update LinkedIn headline (Section 9)
- ☐ Message 5 trusted contacts privately. Not a public spiral.

Done when: List exists and five messages sent or scheduled.

Hour 24–48: Move

Why: Warm beats cold. Cold beats nothing. Nothing is what panic wants you to do.

How:

- ☐ Fix resume with Section 9 formula (one hour max)
- ☐ List 20 target roles—title + company, not "anything remote"
- ☐ Send 5 warm messages (template below). Not 50 spray-and-pray applications.
- ☐ Book one coffee chat or informational interview

Done when: Five outreach messages sent and one conversation on the calendar.

Outreach message template

Hi [Name],

Hope you're well. I'm being proactive about [role type] opportunities in [space] and thought of you given [specific reason].

If you hear of anything—or would spare 15 minutes for perspective—I'd really appreciate it.

Either way, thanks for being in my network.

[Name]

Section 12: Bonus — Team AI Guidelines (If Nobody Else Will)

Your company might never send the "how to use AI here" email. Shockingly, the task force may not save you. If leadership is silent, **proposing light team norms** makes you look like an adult, not a cowboy.

Exercise: Share a one-page draft

Why this matters: You become the person who cares about doing this right—not the person IT has to hunt down after a data leak.

The steps:

1. Copy the template below into a doc.
2. Fill in [brackets]. Delete what doesn't fit your team.
3. Send to your manager: "Happy to refine this with IT—want something lightweight for the team?"
4. Done. You don't need approval to *suggest*. You need approval to *mandate*.

DRAFT: Team AI Use – Proposed Norms

Purpose: Use AI to save time on drafts. Humans own accuracy and judgment.

Approved uses:

- First drafts of internal docs
- Meeting summaries (verified by attendee)
- Brainstorming and outline generation

Requires review before external use:

- Anything client-facing
- HR, legal, or financial content
- Data containing PII or confidential info

Not permitted without approval:

- Pasting confidential data into unapproved tools
- Sending AI output externally without human review

Suggested tools: [align with IT]

Owner for questions: [volunteer or manager]

Done when: The draft exists and one person with authority has seen it. Perfect policy optional. Conversation required.

Quick Reference: Your 30-Day Checklists

Print this page. Stick it somewhere petty—monitor, fridge, inside of a cabinet you open daily. **Why:** Out of sight = out of mind = back to doom-scrolling. **How:** Check boxes every Friday. Takes 90 seconds. Lie to yourself if you want, but the boxes know.

Week 1 — "Who am I here?"

- ☐ Role audit complete (Section 2)
- ☐ "Only me" value list written (at least 3 bullets)
- ☐ Value one-pager drafted (ugly counts)

Week 2 — "Does this actually work?"

- ☐ Two AI workflows in daily use (real work, not practice)

- ☐ Quality checklist used 5+ times (Section 6)

Week 3 — "Does anyone know?"

- ☐ Shared workflow with at least one colleague
- ☐ LinkedIn post OR manager update (pick one—you don't need an audience of thousands)

Week 4 — "Am I ready if things change?"

- ☐ Resume / profile updated (Section 9)
- ☐ Manager conversation sent (Section 7)
- ☐ 30-day retrospective answered (Section 10)

Done when: Most boxes checked. Perfection is for people who never ship.

Section 13: Industry Quick Wins (Pick Your Lane)

You don't need all six lanes below. You need **one** workflow this week that saves time and creates a story you can tell. Find your job in the list. Ignore the rest. No FOMO.

Administrative / Operations

Why this matters: Your value is keeping the machine running—and knowing when the machine is wrong.

Do this:

1. Pick one inbox category you answer every week (scheduling, FAQs, status requests).
2. Paste 3 past replies into AI. Ask: "Draft a template for these."
3. Use the template on the next 5 messages. Edit every one before sending.
4. **Visibility move:** Write a one-page "how to request X from our team." Share it. You're now the process person.

Marketing / Content

Why this matters: AI floods the world with beige content. Your job is **not beige**.

How:

1. Take your next campaign brief (or make a fake one).
2. Run Prompt 7 (slide/outline) or ask for 5 headline options.
3. Rewrite one option in your brand voice. Throw the rest away dramatically.
4. **Visibility move:** Show one before/after at standup. "Draft time down, quality still me."

Customer Success / Support

Why this matters: Bots handle easy tickets. You handle humans who are tired of bots.

How:

1. Open one long ticket thread.
2. Ask AI to summarize + suggest a reply.
3. Rewrite the reply for tone and account history. Send the human version.
4. **Visibility move:** Note if escalations drop or CSAT improves—even informally.

Sales / Account Management

Why this matters: Speed without trust is spam. You're the trust part.

How:

1. After your next call, paste rough notes (no confidential deal terms in unapproved tools).
2. Generate follow-up email + CRM summary bullets.
3. Personalize the first line. Always personalize the first line.
4. **Visibility move:** Offer one peer a 15-minute "how I prep for QBRs" session.

Project Management

Why this matters: Everyone has status updates. Fewer people have **accurate** ones.

How:

1. Dump Slack threads + email + doc comments into AI.
2. Ask for a draft status: done / in progress / blocked.
3. Fix blockers and politics the AI can't see. That's your whole value.
4. **Visibility move:** Own the weekly status template. Become the source of truth.

Finance / HR (extra caution)

Why this matters: One data leak = career detour. You're the guardrail, not the risk.

How:

1. Confirm approved tools with IT. If unclear, ask in writing.
2. Use AI only on anonymized or internal drafts.
3. Never paste SSNs, payroll, or client financials into public tools. Ever. We're not being cute—this is the line.
4. **Visibility move:** Co-draft safe-use norms with legal/IT (Section 12 template).

Exercise: Pick one lane

Why: One finished workflow beats six bookmarked intentions.

How: Circle your lane above. Do steps 1–3 today. Step 4 before Friday.

My lane	Workflow I tried	Time saved (guess)	Who I told

Section 14: FAQ — What People Ask (And Honest Answers)

No corporate spin. No "it depends" without the depends.

Q: Will doing this make me immune to layoffs?

A: No. Nothing does. Not networking. Not being nice. Not working weekends. This playbook improves your **odds** and your **recovery speed** if the worst happens—which is the only honest promise anyone can make.

Q: Should I tell my team I'm using AI?

A: Usually yes. Frame it as "I found a faster way to do X" not "I let the robot do my job." Secrecy makes you look sneaky. Transparency makes you look like someone who shares good ideas.

Q: What if AI makes me faster and they just give me more work?

A: Classic. Reinvest saved time into **visible** higher-value work—not invisible speed that only benefits the spreadsheet. Tell your manager what you're doing with the hours. If they pile on busywork anyway, that's a manager problem, not an AI problem.

Q: Which AI tool should I use?

A: The one your employer approves. If the list is empty, ask (Section 7). If still empty, practice on fake/non-confidential tasks until policy catches up. Sneaking client data into random tools is how people become cautionary tales.

Q: I'm not technical. Is this still for me?

A: You don't need to code. You need to copy, paste, read, and edit. If you can use email, you can do this. The barrier is consistency, not IQ.

Q: How do I know if AI output is wrong?

A: Verify names, numbers, dates, and claims. If you can't verify, don't ship. When in doubt, assume it hallucinated and make it prove itself. Your judgment is the product—you're not being paranoid, you're being employed.

Q: What if my manager thinks AI is cheating?

A: Use Section 7 script. Emphasize QA, approval, and time saved on *drafts*—not final decisions. Offer a demo. Managers fear risk more than they fear efficiency.

Section 15: Worksheet — 30-Day Tracker

Why this matters: Memory lies. "I think I did a lot" is not evidence. Four rows of handwriting is.

How: Every Friday, 5 minutes, fill in one row. Estimate hours saved honestly—rounding up makes you feel good until someone asks for proof.

Week	Hours saved (est.)	Workflow #1 result	Workflow #2 result	Visibility action taken	Manager touchpoint?
1					Y / N
2					Y / N
3					Y / N
4					Y / N

End-of-month scorecard

Why: Numbers focus the mind. Vibes do not survive performance reviews.

How: Rate 1–5. One sentence each. If anything is below 3, schedule 30 minutes next Monday to fix that one thing—not the whole book.

Area	Score	One sentence: what improved?
Clarity on my unique value	/5	
AI workflows in daily use	/5	
Quality control habit	/5	
Visibility to manager/team	/5	
Resume/LinkedIn readiness	/5	
Confidence in next 90 days	/5	

Section 16: The "Do Not Do" List

Learn from other people's Slack disasters. **Why this list exists:** One bad AI send can undo a month of good work. **How to use it:** Read once. Pin mentally. Ignore at your peril.

1. **Blindly sending AI emails** — Wrong name, wrong date, wrong promise. The bot doesn't have to apologize. You do.
2. **Claiming "AI skills" on your resume** without a real workflow story. Interviewers will ask. Awkward.
3. **Posting hot takes** about AI replacing entire professions. You sound scared and loud. Neither helps.
4. **Pasting customer PII or confidential docs** into free public tools. This is the "explain it to HR" category.
5. **Optimizing only for speed** on work nobody measures. Fast and invisible is still invisible.
6. **Job hopping in panic** with no value proof. You'll arrive at the next place with the same anxiety and a shorter tenure line.
7. **Waiting for corporate training** that may never come. You're holding this book. You're already training.

Exercise: Pick the one you're most tempted by. Write it on a sticky note. Label it "Tuesday me, stop."

Section 17: Next 90 Days — After the Playbook

Thirty days gets you moving. **Days 31–90** get you somewhere. No new philosophy—just three phases of straightforward homework.

Month 2: Go deeper

Why: One workflow is a trick. Three workflows is a reputation.

How:

1. Add a third AI workflow tied to something your manager actually measures.
2. Volunteer for one cross-team project where your "synthesis" skill shows up in meetings.
3. Document one process only you understand. Future-you (and your team) will be grateful.

Done when: Someone references your doc or workflow without you prompting them.

Month 3: Choose your path

Why: Drifting feels safe. It's not. Pick a direction on purpose.

How: Read the table. Circle one path. Do the "next step" column this month—not "when things calm down." Things don't calm down.

Path	Signal you're ready	Next step
Grow here	Manager engages on your AI workflows	Ask for expanded scope or to lead team AI norms

Path	Signal you're ready	Next step
Move strategically	One-pager + LinkedIn proof exist	Message 10 warm contacts—not 100 cold apps
Side income	Colleagues keep asking how you do X	Package one workflow as a template or mini-guide

There is no wrong path. There is only **not choosing** and then wondering why nothing changed.

Exercise: 90-day one-liner

Why: If you can't say where you're headed, neither can anyone who might help you.

How: Finish this sentence in one line: *"In 90 days, I want to be the person who _____."*
Put it at the top of your tracker (Section 15).

Done when: It's written. Bonus: tell one trusted person.

Final Word

First: You're allowed to be freaked out

If you've felt a low-grade dread about AI at work—lying awake wondering if your job still exists in three years, nodding through meetings while internally screaming—you're not dramatic. You're paying attention.

Anxiety about AI has outpaced actual layoffs in many industries. That means **fear is running ahead of facts**. Your nervous system doesn't know that. It heard "AI" and filed it under *tiger, possibly hungry*.

That's not weakness. That's being human with a brain that evolved to panic first and spreadsheet second.

What the fear is really about (it's usually not AI)

Most people aren't afraid of a chatbot. They're afraid of:

- **Invisibility** — doing good work nobody notices until someone cheaper (or a bot) does it faster
- **Irrelevance** — watching younger or more technical colleagues become the "go-to" person
- **Loss of control** — policies written without you, tools deployed above you, change happening *to* you
- **Shame** — feeling stupid for not "getting it" while everyone on LinkedIn pretends they've been prompt-engineering since 2019

Notice none of those are solved by buying another course or doom-scrolling tech news at midnight. They're solved by **clarity, evidence, and small brave actions**—which is exactly what the last 15 sections were built for.

A reframe that actually helps

You cannot control whether your company adopts AI. You cannot control macro layoffs, stock prices, or that one VP who thinks "we should AI our way to Q3."

You *can* control:

- Whether you understand your own value (Section 2)
- Whether you practice judgment on top of drafts (Section 6)
- Whether anyone at work knows what you contribute (Sections 5, 7, 9)
- Whether you're employable *outside* this building if you need to be (Sections 9, 11)

Psychologists call this **locus of control**—and shifting even 10% of your energy from "what if" to "what next" measurably reduces work anxiety. Not toxic positivity. Just a better allocation of your limited fucks to give.

Things that are not your job

- Single-handedly saving your company from digital transformation
- Becoming a machine learning engineer by Friday

- Pretending you're fine when you're not
- Winning the AI arms race on Twitter
- Never making a mistake with a new tool (you will; fix it and move on)

Things that *are* your job

- Showing up as someone who solves problems, not someone who hides from tools
- Catching errors before they reach a client (congrats—you're now "AI QA," a real role)
- Building relationships that outlast any software subscription
- Getting 1% better each week for 30 days

Compound interest works on careers too. Boring, but true.

A little humor (because if you don't laugh, you cry in the break room)

Signs you've entered the AI anxiety spiral:

- You asked ChatGPT if your job is safe. It said "great question!" and gave you a numbered list that helped no one.
- You've read three "AI will replace 40% of jobs" headlines and zero articles about the 40% of AI pilots that died in committee.
- Someone said "we're leveraging synergistic AI" in a meeting and you felt your soul leave your body.
- You secretly tested whether AI could do your job and it produced something confidently wrong—with perfect grammar.
- Your company announced an "AI task force" with no budget, no tools, and a kickoff meeting that could have been an email.

The good news: You are still here. You have a playbook. The task force does not.

Reminder: AI does not get tired of corporate jargon. You do. That's a competitive advantage.

Encouragement (the sincere part)

You bought or downloaded this guide because you want to take care of yourself in a confusing moment. That already puts you ahead of people waiting for HR to send a reassuring all-hands that never comes.

You don't need to become a different person. You need to become **more legible**—to yourself first, then to the people who decide scope, promotions, and who stays.

Thirty days is enough to:

- Prove to yourself that you can adapt (you've adapted before; new software, new boss, new "urgent" priority every quarter)
- Build evidence that you're not replaceable by a prompt
- Sleep a little better because you have a plan B in your back pocket

If you stumble on week two and skip four days—welcome to the human race. Don't restart the whole playbook. Pick up at today's date on the calendar. Progress isn't linear. Careers

aren't either. Anyone who tells you otherwise is selling a course.

You are not a deprecated feature. You're a person who does work that matters to other people. Machines don't volunteer to cover a colleague's shift. They don't remember that a client lost a parent last quarter and needs extra patience. They don't stay late because the project actually matters to them.

That's not sentimental. That's your moat.

When imposter syndrome shows up

It will. Especially when you start using AI and worry you're "cheating."

You're not cheating. You're **using a tool**. Did accountants cheat when spreadsheets replaced ledgers? Did designers cheat when they stopped cutting physical paste-ups? Tools change. The standard is still: *is the output good, ethical, and yours to stand behind?*

If you edit it, verify it, and put your name on it—you did the work.

One last psychotherapy nugget (free of charge)

Try this when the spiral hits: **name five things you did well at work in the last month**. Not huge things. Small ones. Unclogged a process. Helped a new hire. Fixed a mistake before it shipped.

Your brain is biased toward threat detection. This exercise retrains it toward evidence. Do it once a week. It sounds corny. It works.

The actual bottom line

AI will keep changing. Models will update. Buzzwords will get worse before they get better.

Your employability in 2026 is not about knowing every new model—it is about **combining speed with judgment, making value visible**, and **owning outcomes** when the draft is wrong.

You have a plan. Run it for 30 days. Then iterate.

You're going to be okay. Not because the world is gentle—it isn't—but because you're willing to prepare instead of just worry.

Now go be the person who makes AI useful *and* keeps the human parts that actually matter.

Your three commitments (sign below):

1. I will complete the role audit by: _____
2. I will run two AI workflows for real work by: _____
3. I will have one visibility conversation by: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____